A report on the work of the IMS Publishing Department

October 2026

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1 Completed work

- Press Coordinator matcha_tea led the Week of Journalism (WoJ, from October 19 to 25), which included the publishing of the following Substack articles:
  1. "Metagaming, raiding, and scientific rigour – what does CivLabs do about it?" by matcha_tea (IMSC: s-ma-6)
  2. "Running a coup d'etat: a look at the means" by Freeve4 (IMSC: s-f4-1)
  3. "Wild or Mild? The Wilderness Bound Update" by Llamangus (IMSC: s-ls-2)
  4. "IMS members are dissatisfied with rule 3" by koviubi (IMSC: s-ki-1)
  5. "What The Sift tells us about Dimensions" by Llamangus (IMSC: s-ls-3)
  6. "The Institute View on The Systems Experiment" by matcha_tea (IMSC: s-ma-7)
  7. "Minecraft Dungeons 2: thoughts and future possibilities" by Turtle2770 (IMSC: s-te-2)
- The Era of Civilisation hack was covered on Substack by Llamangus and matcha_tea on October 20.
- Articles published by the Department have been uploaded to the IMS Zenodo community on October 21. They have thus been assigned DOIs. All future articles will also be uploaded there.
- The mandate of Editor-in-chief matcha_tea ended on October 21. The election was organized by Marqha. The IMS elected koviubi as Editor-in-chief, effective October 26, for a term of three months, ending on January 26. For the sake of transparency, it should be noted that no other eligible candidate ran[1] and the election was not completely in line with the Constitution.[2]

[1] In accordance with §10 of the Constitution, only Department members may stand in elections.

[2] On October 21, we voted 5–0 to suspend "secret, single winner ranked-choice voting" from §10 of the Constitution for one month due to "unavoidable technical difficulties", as an extraordinary action. Ignoring the Constitution should not become commonplace. Moreover, the organizer did not ask three standard questions to the candidate, and the required time frames were not followed.

- The second issue of the IMS Journal (Volume 1 Issue 2) was published on October 28. Four authors, two editors, and five peer reviewers worked to publish the following articles:

    1. "The Ordonian Calculus and the IMS: Stewardship, Agency, and the Economy of Information in The Systems Experiment" by Llamangus (IMSC: j(2)-ls-1)
    2. "Society and Governance Parallels in Minecraft: The Systems Experiment Findings" by Mila (IMSC: j(2)-mia-1)
    3. "Political Philosophy Is Useless for the Study of Servers" by Moldypizzar0ll (IMSC: j(2)-ml-2)
    4. "The removal of agency by server owners and reclaiming player power" by matcha_tea (IMSC: j(2)-ma-8)

    One of the articles planned for this issue was withdrawn by its author. Furthermore, the front cover of this journal issue was designed by Turtle2770.

- On October 28, the #draft-manuscripts forum channel in the main IMS server was updated to make it clearer that Journal articles get selected from there: matcha_tea added an "Open to publishing" tag and added an explanation in the post guidelines.
- In October, we have reached out and established new contacts in CivLabs and CivMC.

2 Planned work

- The Department plans to hold a thorough debriefing in order to discuss what changes could improve our work. After receiving feedback from authors, peer reviewers, and editors through an anonymous survey, discussions will include:
    - issues we face due to the low number of (active) staff and authors;
    - changes needed to elections;
    - ensuring the policies, guides, and the style guide appropriately reflect our practices and expectations;
    - ways to encourage writing (e.g., prompts, idea kick-starters, quests);
    - updates to the publishing workflow of the Press Subdepartment, especially editing;
    - ways to otherwise improve the publishing workflow, especially submission and peer review;
    - unregulated ethical questions regarding experiments, as well as journalism;
    - cooperation opportunities with the Research Department; and

  - how to achieve the goal and vision of the Institute and of the Department.

- A section in the IMS Substack is planned for members to share short (<200 words) thoughts on an article, topic, or other relevant and current issues, managed by the Press Subdepartment.
- We will continue to engage with the IMS's mood to broaden topics we publish on.
- Articles on the Raid Farms/Bloodlines interviews and the CIV event are planned, managed by Press Coordinator matcha_tea.
- The terms of Journal Coordinator koviubi and Press Coordinator matcha_tea end on November 14. Editor-in-chief koviubi will organize the election.
- The mentorship period of a columnist applicant will end on November 17. The Editor-in-chief will decide on their admission, in accordance with policy.
- Work on the third issue of the Journal (Volume 2 Issue 1) is planned to begin in late November/early December, led by the Journal Coordinator.

3 Staff

Through the new "try-out" method, two applicants to the Department began their mentorships in October: one as a reporter, and the other one as an editor.

Thus, the Department has 6 members and 3 mentees.

4 Freedom of information (FoI) requests

The Department received zero FoI requests in October and so has fulfilled zero requests.

Any IMS member may submit a FoI request as outlined in the June 2026 transparency report by messaging the Editor-in-chief.

5 Afterword

The primary issue affecting the work of our Department is still the lack of active staff. If you're interested in helping out, or if you'd like to get to know the Department better, don't hesitate to try it out without an application process: https://imsresearch.pages.dev/pubdep/jobs. There are step-by-step guides available for each role, and an experienced mentor helps you with any questions you may have. You can change your mind anytime; take leaves and come back as you need. We are always welcoming new reporters, columnists, and editors to our team.

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